

RUI SILVA

Senior Creative Operations Leader | Ex-SVP, FARFETCH

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Based in Portugal | Open to remote (EU/global) | EU work authorization

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY

Senior Creative Operations leader with 15 years scaling the creative engine of one of the world's largest luxury fashion platforms. Rose from Production Manager to SVP at FARFETCH, leading a 600+ FTE global organization (900+ with seasonal staff) across 5 countries with a €40M+ P&L. Delivered a 10% → 1% reduction in operational spend through Lean/Kaizen, AI/ML automation, and Virtual Model technology — while maintaining luxury quality. Combines operational rigor at industrial scale with a craft sensibility rooted in textile and graphic design training.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

10% → 1% — operational spend as % of sales, while maintaining luxury quality

€40M+ P&L — annual operational spend across 5-country organization

600+ FTE — 900+ with seasonal staff, across Portugal, UK, US, Hong Kong

3.6M+ assets/yr — 800k SKUs, 4–5 day SLA from arrival to live

€60 → <€30 — cost-per-item via Virtual Model technology

80%+ automation — product categorization; ML translation in 12+ languages

CORE COMPETENCIES

Strategic Leadership — Global org design (600–900 HC), P&L (€40M+), corporate strategy, cross-cultural teams (PT/UK/US/HK)

Operational Excellence — Kaizen/Lean, process engineering, RPA, TD-ABC

Creative Content at Scale — DAM (3.6M+ assets/yr), content supply chain, luxury QA

Technology Transformation — AI/ML content automation, product categorization, machine translation, Virtual Model, RPA

Craft & Design — Graphic, Product Design and Furniture Prototyping — bridges artisanal quality with industrial-scale profitability

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

FARFETCH

2009 – February 2024

Production Manager → SVP Creative Operations (15 years, 6 promotions)

SVP Creative Operations | Feb 2022 – Feb 2024

VP Creative Operations | Aug 2018 – Feb 2022

Owned the end-to-end creative content supply chain — from product arrival to on-platform "live": photography, retouching, styling, copy, translation, categorization, catalogue management, and digital asset production across 5 countries. Led through 4 pillars: Content Development, Content Creation, PPM (Planning, Performance & Management), and SDD (Services Design & Development).

- ▶ Drove a 10% → 1% reduction in operational spend as a percentage of sales — managing a €40M+ annual budget while maintaining luxury quality standards across all output. The signature transformation of the function.
- Led 600+ FTE team (900+ with seasonal staff) across PT/UK/US/HK; 6–7 direct reports
- Built Portugal and Hong Kong studios from scratch; developed and promoted internal talent to leadership roles
- Delivered 3.6M+ digital assets/yr, 800k SKUs, 4–5 day SLA
- Virtual Model tech: €60 → <€30 per item; 80%+ categorization automation; ML translation in 12+ languages
- 30%+ efficiency via Kaizen — 1st place, Kaizen Institute & APGEI

Senior Director, Creative Operations | Jan 2017 – Jul 2018

Guimarães / London / Los Angeles / Hong Kong

- Expanded creative operations into Los Angeles and Hong Kong — built local teams and production from the ground up
- Aligned production standards across four cultural markets with shared workflows and quality gates

Earlier roles at FARFETCH (2009 – 2016)

Production Manager → Production Director → Global Production Director

Built the production engine from the shop floor — the years where the operational culture, quality standards, and process instincts that later scaled to 5 countries were formed. Led production across 4 countries reporting to the COO before stepping into the Senior Director role that expanded the remit into full creative operations.

RUI SILVA STUDIO

Founder & Creative Director | May 2024 – Present

A contemporary collectible furniture practice — one-of-a-kind pieces in oak, steel, brass, and porcelain. A labor of love kept running when time allows.

- Designed and launched the Lusitano Collection — handcrafted furniture inspired by Portugal's Lusitano horse
- Own the full lifecycle: concept, design, sourcing, manufacturing, finishing, brand, website
- A creative practice that keeps my creative mind sharp and informs how I think about creative operations

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Product Owner (CSPO) — Scrum Alliance

CAP — Certificate of Professional Trainer — AEP

Photojournalism — GI Press Office of Guimarães

Multimedia & Web Design — School of Technology / IPFEL

Methods training: Lean Thinking, VSM, SMED, 8D, TD-ABC

AWARDS

Kaizen Lean Excellence on Productivity — 1st Place

Kaizen Institute & APGEI

LANGUAGES

Portuguese (native)

English (professional)